Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J 9 6 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q J 7 ♣ A K Q	
♠ 5 2 ♥ K 9 6 5 ♦ A 4 3 ♣ 10 9 8 6	N W E S	♠ 10 7 3 ♥ Q J 10 2 ♦ 8 6 2 ♣ J 4 3
	♠ A 8 4 ♥ A 8 7 3 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ 7 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

2NT shows a balanced hand with 8+ points, and when SOUTH then supports ♠s NORTH makes a slam try.

NORTH bids RKC Blackwood 4NT. SOUTH shows two Keycards (two Aces) and NORTH bids 6♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 2 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 8 6 3	
♠ K J ♥ Q J 8 5 ♦ Q 10 9 7 ♣ Q 4 2		♠ A Q 7 ♥ K 10 7 4 2 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A K
	♠ 6 5 4 3 ♥ A 3 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ 10 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

5♥ by East
Lead: ♣10

WEST has a decent Limit Raise, and EAST tries RKC Blackwood.

WEST replies to the 4NT bid with 5♦, zero or three Keycards. So which is it, zero or three?

Pretty simple - since EAST holds three Keycards himself WEST can hardly have three also since there are only five total. She must have zero and EAST signs off at 5♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 10 7 4 ♥ K Q J 8 4 ♦ A 6 ♣ A 3	
♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 9 7 6 ♦ J 9 4 3 2 ♣ 7 6		♠ J ♥ A 3 2 ♦ 10 8 5 ♣ J 10 9 8 4 2
	♠ A Q 8 6 3 2 ♥ 5 ♦ K Q 7 ♣ K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣7

NORTH jumps to 4♠, confident that SOUTH could make 10 tricks even if he just has 6 points.

SOUTH knows he can make more and bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ response shows zero or three Keycards. So which is it? Zero or three?

NORTH bid much too strongly to have no Aces. SOUTH bids a confident 6♠, knowing NORTH has either three Aces or two Aces plus the ♠K.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q 10 8 4 2 ♥ 2 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ 8 7 4	
♠ 6 ♥ A K 9 7 5 4 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 3		♠ A 7 5 ♥ Q 10 8 3 ♦ A 8 5 4 ♣ 9 2
	♠ K J 9 3 ♥ J 6 ♦ K 10 9 2 ♣ A 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣4

With eleven cards in the "round" suits WEST has a lot of playing strength. So when EAST bids a Limit Raise in ♥s WEST wants to know about Aces.

RKCBlackwood tells him that EAST has two Aces plus the trump Queen, so WEST can see that 6♥ is practically a certainty.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 8 4 2
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ 8 4
♣ A

♠ 6 5
♥ 8 3
♦ K Q 9 7
♣ J 10 5 3 2

♠ 10
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ A J 5
♣ Q 9 8 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3
♥ A J 5
♦ 10 6 3 2
♣ K 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥4

NORTH has interest in slam after she hears SOUTH's Limit Raise. BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the ♦ suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

SOUTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4♥.

NORTH stops at 4♠ because neither partner controls ♦s.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 4 2
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 5
♣ 10 9 5 3 2

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ A K 9 6 3
♣ K Q

♠ A J 7
♥ J 6
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ A 6 4

♠ K 9 8 5 3
♥ A 9 5
♦ 4 2
♣ J 8 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♦			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♦ by East
Lead: ♣7

WEST decides it is unlikely that EAST is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces EAST does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, EAST bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. EAST has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

WEST bids 6♦. If EAST had just one Key-card, WEST would bid 5♦ over the 5♣ reply.

Board 7
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ K Q ♣ A K 9 6 3	
♠ A J 10 4 ♥ A 9 ♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2 ♣ 2		♠ 9 8 5 3 2 ♥ 10 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 5 4
	♠ K Q 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ Q J 10 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by South
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card. When SOUTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ 4 ♥ 9 7 5 2 ♦ 9 5 4 3 ♣ 8 7 4 2	
♠ A 9 6 ♥ Q J 10 3 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9		♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K 6 ♣ A K 5
	♠ 10 3 ♥ A K 8 6 ♦ 10 8 7 2 ♣ 10 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

6♠ by West
Lead: ♣4

EAST needs to know how many Aces WEST holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 9
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 8 7 4 3 ♥ Q 7 5 ♦ — ♣ 9 7 6 2	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 9 3 ♦ Q J 9 7 4 3 ♣ 8 5		♠ 9 6 ♥ 8 6 4 2 ♦ A 10 8 6 2 ♣ 10 3
	♠ A J 10 5 ♥ A K ♦ K 5 ♣ A K Q J 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♦	Pass	7♠
All Pass			

7♠ by North
Lead: ♦A

NORTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

SOUTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

NORTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

SOUTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 10
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 8 7 2 ♥ J ♦ J 10 9 8 7 4 ♣ A 3	
♠ K Q 3 ♥ K 10 9 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ K Q 9 6		♠ A 6 ♥ A Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 8 7
	♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 5 2 ♣ J 10 5 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦5

EAST jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

WEST has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

EAST responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for WEST to bid the slam.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q 6 4 ♥ A K Q ♦ A 5 ♣ K J 6 3	
♠ J 8 ♥ 10 6 5 3 2 ♦ Q 10 4 ♣ 10 8 7	N W E S	♠ 9 ♥ J 9 7 4 ♦ J 9 7 3 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ K 10 7 5 3 2 ♥ 8 ♦ K 8 6 ♣ A Q 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♣	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by South
Lead: ♥6

When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 12
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 2 ♥ A K 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ 10 8 7	
♠ A K 7 5 3 ♥ 8 ♦ K Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 4		♠ Q 8 6 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A J 5 ♣ A J 6 5
	♠ 10 9 4 ♥ 10 9 6 2 ♦ 9 6 3 ♣ 9 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by West
Lead: ♥K

WEST knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. EAST's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when WEST claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

Board 13
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A Q J 6 5 2 ♥ K 8 2 ♦ Q ♣ A 8 5	
♠ 10 4 ♥ Q 9 4 3 ♦ K J 5 ♣ 10 6 4 2		♠ 8 7 ♥ J 7 5 ♦ 10 7 4 3 ♣ Q J 7 3
	♠ K 9 3 ♥ A 10 6 ♦ A 9 8 6 2 ♣ K 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by North
Lead: ♣Q

When NORTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for SOUTH is to agree on the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

NORTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, NORTH knows they are the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards NORTH knows there aren't enough points for a Grand slam.

Board 14
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ 8 6 4 2 ♥ 10 6 ♦ J 9 6 2 ♣ K J 4	
♠ 9 5 ♥ A K 9 8 7 4 2 ♦ 7 3 ♣ 8 7		♠ A K ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A K Q 5 ♣ A 9 6 2
	♠ Q J 10 7 3 ♥ 5 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ Q 10 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	7NT	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

7NT by East
Lead: ♠Q

It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick losers, but EAST knows WEST would not preempt with a 10-high ♥ suit.

WEST's reply to RKCB is 5♥, showing two Key Cards. EAST knows they are the ♥A ♥K so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes WEST didn't open 3♥ with a 6-card suit.

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 9 6 4 3 ♥ A Q 3 ♦ Q 7 ♣ Q 5 3	
♠ A 2 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 9 4 2 ♣ 10 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ K ♥ J 9 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 6 5 ♣ 9 8 7
	♠ Q 10 8 7 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A K 3 ♣ A K J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

SOUTH has 21 points, and when she hears NORTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

NORTH answers with just one Key Card so SOUTH stops at 5♠, knowing they are missing two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 9 8 7 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 8 2 ♣ Q 10 7 3	
♠ A J 6 ♥ K 7 5 ♦ K Q 5 3 ♣ A J 5		♠ K Q 5 ♥ A Q 9 6 ♦ 7 6 4 ♣ K 9 6
	♠ 10 4 3 2 ♥ J 4 3 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ 8 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	1♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	4NT	
All Pass			

4NT by West
Lead: ♠9

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, WEST showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and EAST invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K 9 7 6 2
♦ K 8
♣ 7 6 4

♠ J 10 4 3
♥ 10 4
♦ A 6
♣ Q J 9 5 3

♠ Q 8 6
♥ 8
♦ 10 9 4 2
♣ A K 10 8 2

♠ A 9 7 2
♥ Q J 5 3
♦ Q J 7 5 3
♣ —

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

When SOUTH makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, NORTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and SOUTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what NORTH needed for the 6♥ bid.

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 5 ♥ 7 6 3 ♦ 3 2 ♣ 10 9 8 6 3	
♠ A K 6 3 ♥ K Q 10 4 ♦ K Q 8 5 ♣ 2		♠ Q 9 8 2 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ K Q J
	♠ 7 4 ♥ J 8 2 ♦ J 10 9 7 ♣ A 7 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When EAST announces four ♠s WEST uses RKCB 4NT.

EAST's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in WEST's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

Board 19
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 6 3
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ K Q 8 5
♣ 2

♠ 10 7 5
♥ J 2
♦ 9 6 2
♣ A 10 9 7 3

♠ Q 4
♥ 8 7 6 3
♦ 10 7 3
♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ J 9 8 2
♥ A 9 5
♦ A J 4
♣ K Q J

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 20
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 9 6 5 ♥ 10 7 ♦ Q J 9 8 ♣ K 10 3	
♠ A K 4 ♥ J 9 5 ♦ A K 7 6 ♣ A 5 4	N W E S	♠ 7 3 2 ♥ A K Q 8 6 4 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7
	♠ Q 10 8 ♥ 3 2 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ Q J 9 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♦Q

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if WEST decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when EAST shows two Key Cards.

WEST has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking EAST to further describe his hand. EAST should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

EAST cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so WEST just passes 3NT.

Board 21
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q J 8 6 2 ♥ K Q 7 ♦ K Q J ♣ A	
♠ 10 7 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ A 10 3 2 ♣ J 10 7 3		♠ 9 4 ♥ J 8 4 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ K Q 9 8 2
	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 9 5 2 ♦ 8 5 4 ♣ 6 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by North
Lead: ♠9

NORTH realizes SOUTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

SOUTH shows two Key Cards and NORTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces NORTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 9 8 4 ♥ J 8 ♦ K Q 10 7 4 ♣ 7 6 5	
♠ A 7 2 ♥ Q 7 4 ♦ 9 8 5 ♣ 9 8 4 3		♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q
	♠ 10 6 3 ♥ 10 9 3 ♦ A J 3 2 ♣ J 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♣[2]	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣J

WEST's 3♥ bid is "encouraging" so EAST bids 4NT.

When WEST shows one Key Card, (an Ace), EAST is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

WEST has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6♥.

Board 23
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 7 2 ♥ J 9 8 7 4 ♦ 8 5 ♣ 8 4 3	
♠ 9 8 3 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q J 7 4 ♣ J 10 7 6		♠ 10 6 4 ♥ Q ♦ A K 10 9 3 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ J 7 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ J 9 8 6 4 ♣ 10 7 3	
♠ 8 5 ♥ K Q 9 6 4 ♦ 7 3 ♣ A K 8 5		♠ A K 9 6 3 ♥ A J 7 5 ♦ K Q 2 ♣ 6
	♠ Q 10 4 ♥ 3 2 ♦ A 10 5 ♣ Q J 9 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♠[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

EAST cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing WEST cannot pass after her jump-shift.

WEST tries to stop at game but EAST is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when WEST shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.